

NOTICE OF CHALLENGE

Monaco Energy Class

Monaco AI Class

Monaco SeaLab Class

Organiser

The Monaco Energy Boat Challenge (MEBC) is organised and owned solely by the Yacht Club de Monaco:
Quai Louis II, 98000 Monaco - Telephone: +377 93 10 65 05 - Website: www.ycm.mc

All inquiries may be sent to: energychallenge@ycm.mc

Event website: energyboatchallenge.com

Event location

The MEBC Challenge shall be held:

Paddocks – AI and Energy Class: Yacht Club de Monaco, Quai Louis II – 98000 Monaco

Marina Mooring – SeaLab Class: YCM Marina, Quai Louis II – 98000 Monaco

Racing:

- For the Monaco Energy and Monaco AI Classes:
in the MEBC Stadium located in the vicinity of the Port Hercules of Monaco
- For the Monaco SeaLab Class:
in Monaco, French and Italian coastal waters

Document Control

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By Yacht Club de Monaco

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PART A – GENERAL

1. Eligible classes

1.1. Each university team is permitted to enter one boat (the “Boat”) in one (1) of the classes below, by validation & invitation from the Organisation:

- ‘Monaco Energy Class’ complying with the Monaco Energy Class Technical Regulations;
- ‘Monaco AI Class’ complying with the Monaco AI Class Technical Regulations;
- The ‘Monaco SeaLab Class’ complying with Monaco SeaLab Class Technical Regulations;

Final Eligibility will only be decided by the Organising Authority after completion of the registration process described hereafter. The Organiser reserves the right to refuse a Team’s application if the quality and the rigour of the application are considered insufficient.

2. Governing Rules

2.1. It is reminded here that the responsibility to decide whether to participate or remain in a race belongs to the Team. Motorboat racing can be unpredictable and therefore involves an element of risk.

2.2. Entrants are expected to act fairly and in good faith in accordance with the regulations.

2.3. By applying, Teams declare that they know and understand the regulations of the event and agree that participation will constitute their full acceptance.

2.4. The Organiser’s decision-making and interpretation of the Rules is final and binding to all Teams.

2.5. Non-compliance with the rules may be penalised by the Organiser. Penalties can include but are not limited to: disqualification, penalty laps in the Endurance race, non-payment of the grant, non-reimbursement of the booking fee etc.

2.6. The Monaco Energy Boat Challenge will be governed by the following rules:

- All applicable local maritime authority rules and regulations;
- This Notice of Challenge and all documents referred within this Notice;
- The Technical Regulations applicable to the class;
- The Racing Rules, Course Descriptions and Briefing Notes handed out in Monaco;
- Any amendments to the rules above issued in writing by the Organiser;

2.7. In the event of conflict:

2.7.1. In the written rules, they shall be applied in the order of precedence as they are listed above;

2.7.2. Between oral instructions and written rules, the written rules shall prevail.

- 2.8.** Energy Class and AI Class Teams are not permitted to use any boat or craft to provide on-water support/assistance to their Boat while racing & in the MEBC stadium. SeaLab Class Teams can have a support/assistance boat as part of their safety protocol. Teams wishing to enter a support boat must contact the Organising Authority by the 15th of May at the latest or the support boat will not be allowed. Mooring and launching in/out of such support boats may be subject to fees.
- 2.9.** All rules, amendments and results are published on the event website.

3. Event Programme

- 3.1.** The program will be announced on the Organiser's website.
- 3.2.** The program may be modified at any time by the organiser, but it aims to follow the timing below:

2026	Time	Monaco Energy, SeaLab & AI Class
Monday July 6 th	11am	Paddocks Open for all the classes
	11am	Energy Class Hull Handover
	11am - 6pm	Registration & Technical Inspection
Tuesday July 7 th	9am	Latest arrival in Monaco
	9am - 6pm	Registration & Technical Inspection
	9.30am	Opening Briefing
Wednesday July 8 th	9am - 5pm	Technical Inspection & Registration
	6 pm	Closure of Technical Inspection and Registration
	7pm	Opening Ceremony
Thursday July 9 th	AM	Parade
	After Parade	Racing
Friday July 10 th	After 8am	Racing
Saturday July 11 th	After 8am	Racing
	8pm	Award Ceremony
Sunday July 12 th	12 (noon)	Paddocks closing - Paddocks must be cleared

- 3.3.** Teams are not authorised to unpack/assemble their equipment before the paddock opening.
- 3.4.** Each Team is required to arrive in Monaco in person with the Team's Boat at Yacht Club de Monaco no later than Tuesday July 7th 2026 at 9am. Failure to comply with this rule may result in disqualification.
- 3.5.** Compulsory Team leader & Pilot's Briefing will be held by the organiser. Schedules will be published on the Official Notice Board. Each Team must be represented by the Pilot(s) and the Radio Operator during the Compulsory Pilot's Briefings. Non-attendance to the Pilot Briefings may result in the team being disqualified for the day's races.

4. Prizes

4.1. Race prizes will be awarded as follows:

- The Overall 'Winner'; 'Runner-up'; and 'Third Place' Team in each Class;
- The 'Speed Record' breaker

4.2. Tech Talk Prizes (University Teams only)

The official Prize Rules will be published on the event website. The prizes will be awarded by an international jury:

- The 'Innovation Prize' recognises and honours the team that demonstrates exceptional innovation in its project.
- The 'Eco Conception Prize' acknowledges initiatives that prioritise eco-conscious design by incorporating comprehensive life cycle assessments.
- The 'Design Prize' recognises outstanding boat design that not only demonstrates engineering excellence but also captivates with their aesthetic brilliance.

4.3. Communication Prize (University Teams Only)

This prize will be awarded by a Team of Communication Specialists:

- The 'Communication Prize' awards the team with the best communication strategy and coverage.

4.4. Monaco Energy Boat Challenge Champion (University Teams Only)

The prize will be awarded as follows:

- 45% of the points awarded based on the race points
- 45% of the points awarded based on the Tech Talk Prizes and Communication Prize:
 - 'Innovation Prize'
 - 'Eco Conception Prize'
 - 'Design Prize'
 - 'Communication Prize'
- 10% of the points awarded based on the e-Championship points

4.5. University Prize

This Prize will be awarded to the university of the Monaco Energy Boat Challenge Champion.

4.6. The 'Race Prizes', 'Tech Talk Prizes', and the 'Communication Prize' are subject to money prizes while the Organiser reserves the rights to announce additional prizes with, or without money donation.

PART B - APPLICATION

5. Team(s)

- 5.1. All Team Members must be declared in the Official Paperwork Documentation & must be officially accredited with the organiser. Substitution of competitors will not be allowed without prior written approval of the Organiser.
- 5.2. Competitors under 18, must provide a parental consent and have a responsible adult person appointed to be present at any time during the event.
- 5.3. The Organiser may limit the number of additional team members allowed during the Event.
- 5.4. Each team must designate:
- A **“Team Manager”** as the main contact with the organisation. After acceptance to the Challenge, the **Team Manager cannot be changed**. The Team Manager is the sole contact person with Organisation Authority that is responsible before, during and after the event for any liability related to the team or the team activities including but not limited to:
 - Regulatory compliance;
 - Safety of the boat, vehicles, equipment and individuals;
 - Actions of team members;
 - Actions of any other individuals associated with the team;
 - A **“Safety Advisor”** who will be the Organisation Authority primary contact for all matters relating to the safety of its team, both on the water and during work on the boats in the paddocks. More generally, the “Safety Advisor” shall ensure the physical and moral integrity of their team at all times during the event.
 - A **“Radio Operator”** as the only person authorised to talk to the Race Direction while the boat is on the water. The “Radio Operator” must be operational to the Race Direction as soon as the boat touches the water.

One person cannot take on multiple roles. Changes in the designation of roles will have to be justified and approved by the Organiser.

- 5.5. Note that only four (4) accreditations are included in the Entry of each team. Accreditations are required to access the YCM, the dedicated allotment, the social events & team benefits. The additional accreditation(s) must be requested in advance and are subject to payment as per *Registration and Fees Paragraph*.

6. Insurance

- 6.1. All boats entering the Challenge (except Energy Class hulls provided by the Organiser) must be insured with reputable insurers for Third Party Liability risks up to €1 million or equivalent in other currencies

for the period when the Boat is in the Principality of Monaco. The insurance may be requested by the Organiser at any time during the event.

- 6.2.** Each Energy Class hulls are insured by the YCM as owner of the hulls. **The YCM Insurance does not cover any damage or loss of any team materials** and equipment that are affixed to or otherwise associated with the hull. Teams are required to arrange their own insurance coverage for such equipment. The YCM shall not be held responsible, under any circumstances, for any damage or loss of equipment, whether occurring before, during, or after the race.
- 6.3.** Each Team Member must be insured for personal accident and medical expenses cover for at least €100,000 per accident. The insurance documentation might be requested by the Organiser as per Official Paperwork Documentation.

7. Registration & Fees

	MONACO ENERGY, SEALAB & AI CLASSES
Online Registration Opens	26 th September 2025
Stage 1: Pre-Registration Closing	9 th January 2026
• Complete online the Pre-Registration form: After activating your Team Dashboard (activation might require a few days-time), fill in the Pre-Registration Form. • Access your Dashboard and submit the Technical Specification Document Form (TSD)	
Stage 2: Confirmation of application (by the organiser)	9 th February 2026
The Team Manager will be informed by E-mail that the team has been selected to move forward with the registration process. Teams not selected at this stage might be placed on a waiting list.	
Stage 3: Submission of Proof-of-Concept Video	No later than the 22 nd May 2026
All teams are required to upload a short video to the Dashboard as proof of concept for their working prototype on water. If complete demonstration is not possible, contact the Organiser one month prior to the deadline.	
Stage 4: Final Acceptance	No later than the 30 th May 2026
The Team Manager will be informed by E-mail that the team has been officially accepted to participate.	
Stage 5: Final Paperwork & Registration Fee Payment	1 st June 2026
Payment of the registration fee of 1290€ (<u>University Teams are exempt if they satisfy 7.2</u>). Payment of extra accreditations. Save in Dashboard: • Official Paperwork Documentation and <i>Proof of Payment</i> • Tech Talk Final Package	
Stage 6: Technical Inspections & Confirmation of Registration in Monaco	From July 6 th 2pm to July 8 th 2026 5pm

- 7.1. Teams not successfully completing their registration process before the end of Stage 6, including successful completion of the Technical Inspections, may not be allowed to sail at all in the Monaco Energy Boat Challenge.
- 7.2. University teams, duly represented by a teacher or academic referee, will be exempt from the Registration Fee upon satisfactory completion of the related paperwork within the specified timeline (See Official Paperwork Documentation).
- 7.3. A Team may withdraw from the Energy Boat Challenge by prompt written notification to the Organiser.
- 7.4. A Team withdrawing from the Event after the 1st of May 2026, will have its Registration Fee refunded only if another boat registers to the event in its position.

8. Tech Talks

- 8.1. An important representation of the Spirit of the Challenge is the organisation of Tech Talks, where each team is invited to present their project to other participants, an international jury, and the public. The Tech Talks are also broadcast live.
- 8.2. Tech Talks are held after racing, or during racing. Emphasis should be placed on the technological innovation, conceptual choices and the technical solutions adopted to attain the best possible level of energy efficiency, or design.
- 8.3. By entering the Challenge, Teams agree that any information & documentation will be open source, and that teams are not entitled to claim confidentiality for any data shared during Tech Talks. Open Sourcing is a fundamental aspect of the spirit of the Tech Talks.
- 8.4. An international Jury will award dedicated Tech Talk Prizes.
- 8.5. Official Rules and guidance for the 2026 Tech Talks will be provided to the Teams on the website.
- 8.6. The official themes of the Tech Talks in 2026 are 'Innovation', 'Eco-Conception' and 'Design'.
- 8.7. **It is mandatory for each Team to submit at least one Tech Talk package based on the Official Rules to complete their registration, but one team can participate in several or ALL Tech Talks.**

9. Charging of Boats

9.1. Monaco Energy and Monaco AI Classes

Each team must recharge their energy container, ashore in Monaco, in their designated paddock area. For those using electrics, shore power points will be provided by the Organisation for Type F plugs – 16A – 220V.

9.2. Monaco SeaLab Class

9.2.1. Each team may recharge their energy container afloat in Monaco, once moored in their designated area. For those using electrics, only charging equipment contained in the boat may be used; one (1) shore power point (CEE 3P+N+T - 32A - 380/420V) will be provided per Team by the Organisation.

9.2.2. Boats requiring different charging means must contact the Organiser in writing at least one month prior to the start of the event.

9.3. Hydrogen and other

Teams using hydrogen or other energies will be given instructions in due time on how to deliver, store and refill. Strict adherence to these rules must be always followed.

A specific hydrogen declaration data sheet will have to be provided to the Organiser.

10. Support to the Teams

10.1. Paddocks

A minimum of 3m-by-3m dedicated allotment will be put at the disposal of each Team participating in the AI and Energy Classes. Each allotment will be provided with electricity and Wi-fi.

10.2. Accommodation

YCM offers free accommodation for up to **4 people** per Team, to the teams which are part of a university, such as legally and administratively represented by a teacher or an academic referee.

Accommodations will be in the neighbourhood of Monaco.

Check-in 6th of July and Check out 12th of July 2026 (6 nights inc. city taxes).

Accommodation details will be provided at confirmation of participation. Teams will not be able to change the allocated apartment provided by the organiser. In case of anticipated arrival or delayed departure, Teams are responsible to advise the designated accommodation location and organise the appropriate payment with them.

Teams are responsible for the cost of meals and additional services.

10.3. Parking

Cars must be parked in public car parks or parking spaces. Vouchers will be available at registration to park in public car parks surrounding the club estimated at the cost of €20.00 per day. The Yacht Club de Monaco will not be held responsible if your vehicle is parked illegally and fined or towed away.

Parking will be available for vans over 2,45m (with prior approval from the Organiser) and trailers, free of charge during the event.

10.4. Energy Class Hulls

The hulls will be available on the first day of the event as specified in the Official Program and will have to be returned the day after the last race of the event free of any stickers.

A hull loan agreement, free of charge, will be signed at the time of handover of the hulls. Teams will be responsible for any damage to the hulls during the event.

10.5. University Grant Scheme

We believe that all teams should have an equal opportunity to succeed in the competition, regardless of their country of origin. By providing university grants based on distance to the challenge and GDP per Capita, we aim to ensure that all teams have the resources they need to participate.

The Grant table will be made available on the Team Dashboard. The grants will be awarded under the following conditions:

- 10.5.1. Having officially applied for the grant scheme in the Official Paperwork Documentation.
- 10.5.2. Having complied with the Notice of Challenge and Technical Rules of its dedicated class.
- 10.5.3. Having submitted a qualitative Tech Talk presentation in time.
- 10.5.4. Having respected the accommodation rules and taken good care of the equipment handed over to the team for the competition.
- 10.5.5. Having participated in the Challenge in a spirit of fair-play and respected the rules and instructions from the Organisation.

The University Team Grant may be subject to a deduction or cancellation of the grant if the team does not comply with one or more of the conditions listed above.

10.6. Mentoring Program

A mentoring program is being set up for teams who would like to be accompanied. The teams will be assigned a mentor from the industry after selection from the Technical Committee.

10.7. International Transport

For teams shipping their boats, teams have the obligation to follow the *International Transport Procedures* which are available on the team dashboard. It is requested that all teams using such means read these regulations carefully.

11. *Media, Advertising and Logos*

11.1. *Sponsors*

A Team may obtain sponsorship provided that, in the sole discretion of the Organiser, such sponsorship does not conflict with the ethical standards, commercial interests, or other legitimate interests of the Organiser, the Organising Partners, or the Monaco Energy Boat Challenge. Number of sponsors on Pilot's overall, helmet and team members' t-shirts are not limited.

Please note that for all classes, the first third of the hull is dedicated to the Organisation. No sponsor or visuals except the visuals provided by the Organisation Authority should be display on this part of the hull.

Details of any proposed sponsorship (including sponsors' names and the types of products and/or services offered by sponsors) must be included in the Pre-Registration Form. A Team breaching this Clause may, at the sole discretion of the Organiser, be disqualified from the Monaco Energy Boat Challenge.

A Team is not permitted to add sponsorship and/or advertising graphics to the Boat after Technical Inspection without the Organiser's prior written approval.

If a Team obtains a partnership with a watch, car or bank brand, it must inform the YCM's partnership department so that the logo can be approved for the boat's design by writing to clubpartenaires@ycm.org

The Paddocks are reserved for the Team Boats, no additional communication material such as wind flag, roll ups etc. may be added.

11.2. *Organiser's Logos*

A Team is not permitted to apply or use any logos, marks or distinguishing features belonging to the Organiser or the Organising Partners without the Organiser's prior written approval.

11.3. *Graphics*

The Organiser reserves the right, on its sole approval, to disapprove any graphics on the Boat or otherwise which it considers inappropriate and/or offensive. Failure to remove any such graphics or comply with this provision may result in disqualification of that Team.

11.4. *Media*

Each Team is required to provide comments to the media and attend media events for broadcast purposes, if requested to do so by the Organiser.

PART C – PHILOSOPHY & DISCLAIMER

12. *Organisation, communication and promotion*

By entering the Monaco Energy Boat Challenge, the Team expressly acknowledges and agrees:

- a) and warrants that they have obtained permission from their sponsors and commercial partners (wherever appropriate) that the Organiser and the Organising Partners are hereby granted a perpetual, irrevocable, royalty free licence to reproduce, print, publish or disseminate worldwide and in any medium the names, logos, images, likenesses and voices of the Team and the Boat for any reason whatsoever and in particular in connection with the promotion, advertising, broadcasting and commercial exploitation of the Monaco Energy Boat Challenge;
- b) in promoting the Monaco Energy Boat Challenge, the Organiser reserves the right to use any images, sounds, videos and interviews of the Participants, their families and friends, on any media, during their preparation and when they are in the zone of the Event, in Switzerland, Europe and the rest of the world;
- c) that the Organiser may request to place a video or photo camera (GoPro or similar, provided by Organiser) on Team Boat or Pilot's helmet;
- d) that any technological know-how, copyright, patents, design rights (whether registered or unregistered) and any other intellectual property rights, trade secrets and other valuable and/or commercially sensitive information (the "IPR") may be disclosed to the public by the Organiser, the Organising Partners or their agents or representatives. In particular, the Organiser and the Organising Partners are under no duty or expectation of confidence in connection with the IPR;
- e) and warrants that its Boat has been developed solely by the Team and/or that the Team has obtained all necessary licenses and permissions to use the technology, know-how and intellectual property embedded or employed in the Boat;
- f) and undertakes to indemnify the Organiser and the Organising Partners to the fullest extent permitted by law, against all liabilities, costs, expenses, damages and losses including any direct, indirect or consequential losses, loss of profit, loss of reputation and all interest, penalties and legal costs on an indemnity basis and all other costs and expenses sustained or incurred by the Organiser or the Organising Partners arising out of or in connection with a breach of this Clause.

13. Safety

It is the responsibility of the Team to decide whether to compete in the Event. Motorboat racing can be unpredictable and therefore involves an element of risk.

By entering the Monaco Energy Boat Challenge each Team expressly acknowledges and agrees that:

- a) Each Team Member is aware of the risks involved in powerboat racing;
- b) It accepts responsibility for all its Team Members due to exposure to such risks;
- c) Each Team Member clearly understands that the provision by the Organiser of race management; safety boats and/or race officials does not relieve the Team of its responsibilities under the Rules;
- d) The safety of the Team, the Boat and other Teams and Boats is the primary consideration during the Monaco Energy Boat Challenge;
- e) It is responsible for the safety of the Boat, all Team Members and all Team property whether afloat or ashore;
- f) It accepts responsibility for any injury, damage or loss caused by its or its Team Members' acts or omissions;
- g) It will ensure that the Boat will be in sound working order, seaworthy and fit to participate in the Monaco Energy Boat Challenge;
- h) It will ensure the sea trials out of the YCM Marina are conducted as indicated in this Notice of Challenge;
- i) It will ensure no work is carried out on the boat while the boat is on the water (not for the boats staying afloat for the duration of the challenge);
- j) It will ensure that no team member works on the boat when wet;
- k) It will ensure that, at all times while the Boat is on the water, the Pilot and/or Alternate Pilot will be in radio contact with a Team Member ashore. That communication system will be checked by the Organiser during the Technical Inspection; and All its Team Members will be courteous to all other Boats, Teams and Team Members participating in the Monaco Energy Boat Challenge, the Organiser, the Organising Partners and their assistants and representatives as well as all other water users.

14. *Disclaimer of Liability and General Conditions*

The Notice of Challenge (NoC) and the terms of the contract created by a Team entering the Monaco Energy Boat Challenge shall be governed by the laws of Monaco. The Parties hereby expressly agree that any dispute which is not resolved in accordance with the Rules shall be referred to the exclusive jurisdiction of the courts of Monaco.

Each Team shall be responsible for reading, understanding, and complying with these Rules. In registering to take part, each Team accepts to comply with the Monaco Energy Boat Challenge Rules and with the Organiser's decisions.

- l) It is an express condition of entry to the Event that: i) the Disclaimer of Liability Form is accurately and fully completed and signed by each Team Member at the confirmation of registration in Monaco; and ii) each Team accepts that it is entirely responsible for its own and its Team Members' safety, whether afloat or ashore, and nothing, whether in the Rules or elsewhere, reduces the Team's responsibility.
- m) It is for each Pilot to decide whether the Boat is seaworthy and/or fit to compete in any conditions that may be encountered during the Monaco Energy Boat Challenge. By going to sea and participating in a race, parade or exhibition, the Pilot hereby expressly undertakes and confirms that the Boat is seaworthy and fit in all respects and that the Team is competent to compete in any conditions that may be encountered during the Monaco Energy Boat Challenge.
- n) The Organiser hereby excludes all liability for property damage, death and personal injury sustained at sea or on land in connection with, prior to, during and/or after the Monaco Energy Boat Challenge, to the fullest extent permitted by law. Nothing done by the Organiser, the Organising Partners and any of their subsidiaries, associated companies, consultants, agents, representatives, race committee, race officer, trustee, support boat, sponsor, supporter and other company and organisation officially involved with the Monaco Energy Boat Challenge will reduce the responsibility of the Team nor will it make the Organiser responsible for any loss, damage or personal injury, however the same may have occurred, as a result of the Team's participation in the Event.
- o) Each Team and/or Team Member hereby undertakes to indemnify the Organiser and/or the Organising Partners jointly and severally and to the fullest extent permitted by law for any damage, loss, liability, costs, and fees incurred (whether directly or indirectly) by the Organiser and/or the Organising Partners in connection with the Team's acts or omissions in connection with the Monaco Energy Boat Challenge.
- p) All accidents, whether on or off the water, must be notified in writing to the Organiser immediately. Failure to do so may result in either a points penalty and/or a disqualification from particular race(s) or the entire Monaco Energy Boat Challenge.
- q) If any provision in this NoC is deemed invalid, void or inapplicable the remainder of this NoC shall nevertheless remain in full force and effect.
- r) These Rules form the entire agreement between the Organiser and the Teams entering and participating in the Monaco Energy Boat Challenge and the Organiser hereby expressly reserves the right to revise the Rules at any time and will take all reasonable steps to notify participants of such revisions in the form of email notifications to each Team and bulletins being posted on the Organiser's notice board at the YCM during the Monaco Energy Boat Challenge.

s) Cancellation of the races and/or the Monaco Energy Boat Challenge:

- In the event that the Organiser abandons or cancels any race of the Monaco Energy Boat Challenge due to adverse weather or any other reason, no liability shall attach to the Organiser;
- The Organiser reserves the right to cancel the Monaco Energy Boat Challenge entirely, in such circumstances: i) the contract between the Organiser and the Teams will be terminated forthwith by email notice from the Organiser to each Team using the Team's contact email address set out on the duly completed Entry Form; and ii) each Team and Team Member hereby expressly agrees that any claim of any nature whatsoever against the Organiser is expressly excluded and undertakes to indemnify the Organiser in respect of any claim brought by anyone associated with them and/or any costs incurred by the Organiser in relation to any such claim.